

Sambhav Daffu

sambhav.daffu@thinkdigit.com

Imagine a world where you are no longer tied to your routine, no longer do you have to suffer the daily grind of commuting, you don't have to report to the office on time or sit through those boring meetings. Take that guitar class you always wanted to, or learn to swim or paint or travel around the world or do what ever you wanted. The idea is to break the regular monotony of life and to engage yourself in something relevant and meaningful. Sounds wonderful doesn't it?

What is it?

It's the future we all have been waiting for or rather dreamt of. The Venus Project is something of a Utopian concept which is the brain child of Jacques Fresco. It proposes a society of equals – where there is no discrimination, no elitism of any kind. People are free to choose what they want to do, there is no rat race or any sense of competition. We'll dive deeper into the world of the Venus Project in a bit, but first, let's throw some light on Jacques Fresco, because you're probably beginning to wonder if he's off his rocker.

Fresco is a futurist who visualises and designs the future. He has been working on the Venus Project for close to 50 years now. He has been involved in industrial design and social engineering all his life – even designing concepts and systems for aviation companies and the US Army. He has authored more than nine books and has appeared in more than five films. A large part of the *Zeitgeist Addendum* (January Omega DVD) features Fresco and his ideas. The point we're trying to make is that he's not a Loony. Fresco wants to build a society which is devoid of war, hunger and poverty. To achieve this, he proposes that we use two main ingredients – a resource based economy (RBE) and Technology.

Why is this better than the current system?

Whenever an idea like this springs up, your first reaction would assume that



Utopia right here right now!

Wouldn't it be great if you could order for an iPad from your 3D display and have it delivered without having to pay anything for it? Welcome to the Good Life!

the whole concept was the result of one pot-filled evening where everyone having a gala time suddenly decided to take up the mantle to change the world. On the contrary that does not seem to be the case with this one, at least not yet. What the Venus Project proposes is definitely better than our current system as it does not exploit the earth's resources, it talks about sustainable development and use of renewable sources of energy and universal healthcare. It basically engages in all the things that would make this world a better place to live.

Resource-based economy

If Fresco is to be believed the ideas and concepts that he proposes are all possible, and can be put into effect – right now. The only trouble is that the whole world should agree to them! Resource-based economy (RBE) essentially says that all the Earth's resources, which are in abundance should be made available to every citizen of this planet. The idea is to

move from scarcity to abundance, which is only possible if we harness the power of renewable sources of energy such as solar, wind and thermal. He claims non-renewable sources of energy too are available in huge amounts, but the monopolistic nature of today's economy prevents them from being made available.

He even wants to get rid of money. Earth's resources should be available to all without a price tag and without exchange of money. If we all share what we have, then we can eradicate poverty, hunger and war. In the words of Fresco "It calls for a scientific redesign of our culture in which war, poverty, hunger, debt, and unnecessary human suffering are viewed as not only avoidable, but totally unacceptable. Anything less will result in a disastrous continuation of the problems inherent in today's world"

The reason misery exists in this world is because of scarcity. If every resource is freely available to everyone then these social evils can be rooted out.